

There are users and then there are power users, but the difference between the two is just a matter of getting the same things done more efficiently. All the software that we use get regular updates, and not everyone has the time to go through the logs and figure out which new features are important to them. Over a period of time, there can be a lot of features creeping into the most familiar tools, and even long term users may be totally unaware of it. In here, you will find tips that will make your life easier, improve your productivity, maintain the health of your hardware, and ultimately get the most out of your machines. Some of these tips are things you need to do only once, while others are about developing a good habit, and still others point to power features in common software that are rarely used. This is your guide to becoming a power user.

Team Digit | feedback@digit.in

01 Underclock for more

If your PC heats up a lot and you experience performance throttling, then underclock your CPU by 100-200 MHz using software such as Intel Extreme Tuning Utility or Ryzen Master and



ensure better performance on average. In Intel XTU, you will have the multiplier slider under Basic Tuning and in Ryzen Master, simply create a new profile and then drop the multiplier by two. It's not necessary to drop the multiplier to solve the throttling issue, you can always get a better cooler.

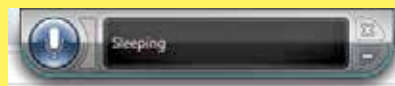
02 Lose the old ones

Make use of the dual-band feature in your router and shift your legacy devices onto the 2.4 GHz band. Older 802.11a/b/g devices will downgrade your entire network, so the better alternative is to upgrade them all for a better overall user experience. The downgrade often isn't as crippling as most imagine it to be, but nevertheless does affect your network.

New routers will have smart connect features that automatically assign the older device to the 2.4 GHz band and the newer ones to the 5 GHz band. For slightly older routers, you'll have to sort them out manually.

03 Type with voice

You can use Cortana to dictate emails, and it works well with third party services including Gmail. Windows also has the basic functionality of allowing you to type anywhere, using your voice. This works with any text input. Go to **Control Panel > Ease of Access > Start Speech Recognition**. There is a rudimentary setup involved that will make you speak a few lines to calibrate the microphone. Then, you can choose to toggle the feature through voice activation or manual activation, and whether or not to initiate speech



recognition at Startup. After that, you are good to go, anywhere a cursor appears, you can just type with your voice. There are also commands available for dictation, such as start a new line, delete a paragraph, insert punctuation marks and so on. Some commands can take a while to process, so watch for

the indicator on the top of the screen. If you have a thick Indian accent, then this feature will not work well.

04 Record your clicks

Problem Step Recorder helps you record your clicks and takes a screenshot everytime you click somewhere. To do this, go to Run, type "PSR" and hit **[Enter]**. Once PSR is open, hit Start Record. Now all your clicks will be recorded until you hit Stop Record. Once you do that, a window will open with the screenshots along with a brief description of your action. This can also be saved and sent to someone, preferably an expert, for further analysis in case you're having some problems with your PC.

05 Text Scaling

If you have a 4K display, or need the text to be bigger for any reason, there is a way to scale the text. From the Start button, search for Display, click on "Advanced Scaling Settings", and set a number in custom scaling size. You can feed in any value between **100% to 500%**.

06 Hide Notifications

You can choose which applications are allowed to serve notifications on your desktop. In Settings, go to Notifications